

MICRO-SECTION OF LIVER

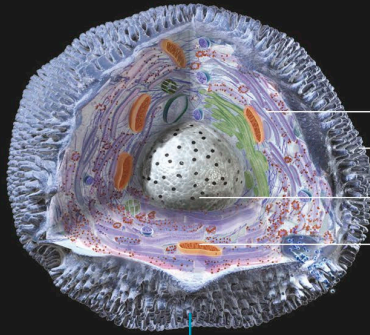
In this magnified section of liver tissue, the cells (pink) and their nuclei (dark purple) are visible. Blood cells lie in the lighter areas between the cells (hepatic sinusoids).

Kupffer cell

Also known as a hepatic macrophage, a type of white blood cell specific to the liver that engulfs and digests old worn-out blood cells and other debris

4 TISSUE

The unique tissue of the liver consists of branching sheets, or laminae, of liver cells (hepatocytes) arranged at angles. These are permeated by fluids and microscopic branches of two main kinds of tubes: blood vessels and bile ducts.



Cytoplasm

Cell membrane

Nucleus

Mitochondrion

5 CELL

The fundamental living unit of all body tissues, a typical cell is capable of obtaining energy and processing nutrients. The hepatocytes of the liver are examples of body cells, containing most types of the miniature structures known as organelles inside them.

Bile canaliculus

Smallest branch of bile duct; snakes between hepatocytes

Sinusoid

A blood vessel with many pores that allow for the exchange of oxygen and nutrients

Hepatocyte

Bile duct

Collects bile fluid, made by hepatocytes, from canaliculi

Branch of hepatic portal vein

Branch of hepatic artery

Red blood cell

Lymph vessel

Central vein

White blood cell

Fat-storing cell

